

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 331

By Terry

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Middle Tennessee State University Blue Raiders club hockey team, Ameritrans Cup and College Hockey South Conference champions.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to specially honor and commend those successful collegiate teams that, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors for this State; and

WHEREAS, the Middle Tennessee State University (MTSU) Blue Raiders club hockey team achieved an extraordinary level of success during the 2024-2025 season, winning their first ever Ameritrans Cup, which is awarded to the champions of the College Hockey South Conference; and

WHEREAS, the MTSU Blue Raiders hoisted their first ever Ameritrans Cup by defeating the University of South Florida (USF) Bulls by a score of 4-0 to clinch the program's first College Hockey Conference championship on February 23, 2025; and

WHEREAS, on their path to their first ever conference championship, the Blue Raiders defeated Tampa 6-2 and Ole Miss 4-1 before their ultimate victory over USF to secure the right to hoist the Ameritrans Cup; and

WHEREAS, the 2024-2025 MTSU Blue Raiders enjoyed the services of an outstanding coaching staff led by Head Coach JJ Murray, who instilled in these exceptional young men a commitment to excellence in all they do and encouraged maximum effort on the ice; and

WHEREAS, conference championships are won through hard work, dedication, and a commitment to working together as a team and excelling with a cooperative spirit; the Blue Raiders exhibited each of these rare qualities during their championship season; and

WHEREAS, the hockey players of MTSU epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved the highest level of success on the ice while showing the highest degree of character both on and off the ice; they inspired their fellow students and united the entire community during their triumphant run through the 2024-2025 season; and

WHEREAS, the dedication, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible the first ever conference championship season in program history but also surely bode well for their success in every future endeavor; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the hockey players of Middle Tennessee State University for serving as exemplars of the high quality of the youth of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the players, coaching staff, team support staff, administrators, and fans of the Middle Tennessee State University Blue Raiders club hockey team on lifting the 2024-2025 Ameritrans Cup as College Hockey South Conference champions.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.